

ProcessorWatch — TakeCard Merchant Drop Monitor

Monitors 400 high-risk merchants for payment processor changes and alerts you the moment someone gets dropped — so you can call before anyone else does.

What it does

- Visits each merchant's checkout/cart page every 12 hours
- Detects which processor they're using (Stripe, Shopify Payments, Square, etc.)
- Spots fallback signals: crypto added, "pay by check", card unavailable
- Fires SMS + email alert the moment something changes
- Web dashboard shows all 400 merchants + alert history

Setup (15 minutes)

1. Install Python dependencies

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

2. Set up Twilio SMS (free trial at [twilio.com](https://www.twilio.com))

- Create account, get a phone number
- Fill in CONFIG in monitor.py:
 - twilio_sid, twilio_token, twilio_from, twilio_to

3. Set up email alerts (Gmail recommended)

- Enable 2FA on Gmail, create App Password
- Fill in CONFIG in monitor.py:
 - smtp_user, smtp_pass, alert_email_to

4. Initialize the database and load merchants

```
python seed_merchants.py
```

5. Run a test scan

```
python monitor.py --scan
```

6. Launch the dashboard

```
python dashboard.py
```

Open <http://localhost:5000>

7. Run in production (always-on monitoring)

```
python monitor.py --schedule
```

Deploy to Railway.app (free)

1. Push code to GitHub
2. Connect repo to Railway
3. Set start command: `python monitor.py --schedule`
4. Done — runs 24/7 for free

Files

- `monitor.py` — Core scanning engine + alert system
- `dashboard.py` — Web dashboard (Flask)
- `seed_merchants.py` — Loads all 400 leads into database
- `requirements.txt` — Python dependencies
- `processorwatch.db` — SQLite database (auto-created)

Alert types

-  PROCESSOR DROP — A known processor disappeared from checkout page

-  FALLBACK SIGNAL — Crypto, check payment, or “unavailable” message appeared
-  CRITICAL — All processors gone simultaneously

The pitch window

When an alert fires you have 24-48 hours before competitors find out. Call immediately with: “We process for [similar merchant in same category] — sounds like you may be having some payment issues. We can have you live in 48 hours.”